Technical Requirements

What the ADHD Budgeting App must do and the rules it must follow, in plain words · AI Development Residency, Fall 2026

What we learned, and what the app must do

About 1 in 14 adults has ADHD, which makes planning, remembering and focusing harder. Money needs all three. Our research shaped every rule below.

What we learned	So the app must…
Long setups wear people out	Set up in 5 minutes and save your place
Out of sight is out of mind	Show your safe-to-spend number first, and count down to bills
Long lists of numbers are hard to keep in your head	Show money in 3 buckets: Spending, Bills, Savings
Busy, flashing screens overwhelm	Have one choice per screen and calm motion
Missed days and red numbers cause shame	Offer a fresh start and kind words, with no streaks
Reward-and-punish tools backfire	Let people set their own goals and help design the app
Quick, impulsive taps are common	Log spending in 2 taps with undo, and count a triple tap once
Adults with ADHD symptoms save less and put off money choices	Keep choices small, and give savings its own bucket
Trust takes time	Work without a bank link at first

Keeping money safe

- **Locked:** money data is scrambled on the phone, and only your face, finger or passcode opens it.
- **Auto-lock:** after 5 idle minutes.
- **Private:** money hides when you switch apps; accounts show only the last 4 digits.
- **Careful:** a tap counts once, and a failed save undoes itself.

How it works

- **Steady:** works offline and never loses or doubles a save.
- **Fast:** your number shows within 5 seconds.
- **For everyone:** screen readers, big text and motion turned off.
- **Built with:** Expo (iPhone and Android), Supabase (backup), Plaid (banks).

The skills we created

A **skill** is a recipe card for Claude Code, our AI coding helper: it reads the matching card before building each part, so it follows our rules every time. **We wrote these 10 skills ourselves:**

Skill	What it teaches Claude Code
`mvp-scope`	Which features go in the first version
`adhd-ux-guidelines`	How to make calm, kind screens
`safe-to-spend-math`	How to do the money math correctly
`banking-security`	Locks, blur, auto-lock and the double-tap guard
`fintech-security-privacy`	How to protect keys and bank links
`local-data-and-state`	How to save data safely on the phone
`mobile-accessibility`	How to work with screen readers and big text
`reminders-and-notifications`	How to send gentle reminders
`testing-react-native`	How to test, starting with what could go wrong
`dev-workflow`	How to build in small, checked steps

We also added **12 expert skills**: 8 from Expo, plus guides for Supabase, app speed, finding bugs and double-checking work.

How we check it

- **Automatic tests** on every change, written for what could go wrong first.
- **4 hands-on checks** on a real phone each sprint: money hides in the app switcher, stays hidden after the phone wakes, a triple tap saves once, and the app locks after 5 minutes.

Sources: Accessibility Checker (2026); UXPA (2025); Din Studio (2025); Design Monks (2026); iFactory (2025); Spiel et al., CHI 2022; Bangma et al., PLOS ONE 2020. Full detail: Technical Requirements Document and banking security requirements in the project repository.